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This instruction implements guidance to Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 36-24, *Military Evaluations.* It prescribes United States Air Force Academy (USAFA) responsibilities for all mission partners (MP) to provide cadet feedback and procedures for the administration of the Military Performance Appraisal (MPA) and the MPA Application in the Cadet Administrative Information System (CAMIS). This Instruction applies to all personnel who evaluate and/or provide feedback to cadets on their aptitude for commissioned service and officership potential. DAFPD 36-24 should be reviewed by all USAFA personnel needing further guidance on the cadet evaluation system. This publication applies to the United States Space Force. Compliance with the attachments in this publication is mandatory. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using Department of the Air Force (DAF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*. This publication may not be supplemented or further implemented/extended. The authorities to waive requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier 3 (T-3) number following the compliance statement. See DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority. The waiver authority for non-tiered requirements in this publication is the USAFA Cadet Wing Vice Commandant (CW/CWV). Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

The instruction incorporates significant changes to paragraphs, references, and attachments. Additionally, a new subjective rating scale reflecting a forced distribution model has been added to reduce MPA inflation. Furthermore, changes to objective and subjective components have been added and weights have been modified.

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1. Overview.

1.1. **Purpose.** The purpose and intent of the Military Performance Appraisal (MPA) process is to provide a systematic developmental and evaluation mechanism to compare cadets to their peers and develop them into Officers of character prepared to lead on day one of active-duty service. To accomplish this, several supportive outcomes are required of the MPA system. The first is to establish performance standards and expectations for the ratee, meaningful feedback on how well the ratee is meeting those expectations, and direction on how to better meet those established standards and expectations. The second is to provide a reliable, long-term, cumulative record of performance. The third is to provide supervisors, enlisted leaders, and commanders with sound information to assist in identifying personnel for career and personnel management decisions. The fourth is to document substantive negative behavioral trends that may preclude future commissioning.

1.1.1. To accomplish these purposes, the evaluation system focuses on performance. How well the individual does their job, and the qualities the individual brings to the job, are of paramount importance to the U.S. Air Force (USAF) and U.S. Space Force (USSF). The evaluation system emphasizes the importance of performance in several ways--using periodic performance feedback, as the basis for formal evaluations, and routine assessment of the skills, knowledge, and abilities USAFA requires of officer candidates.

1.1.2. The MPA process provides cadets a means to develop through feedback within their cadet chain of command and serves as an assessment tool measuring cadet performance and effectiveness in achieving USAFA Outcomes and DAF Pre-commissioning requirements. Thus, the MPA program is intentionally aligned with Commissioning Outcomes outlined in DAFI 36-2614, *Pre- Commissioning Education and Training Program*; AF Officer Evaluation criteria from AFI 36-2406, *Officer and Enlisted Evaluation Systems*; and USAFA Institutional Outcomes. The Cadet Leadership Qualities (CLQs) identified at the core of the performance appraisal process were derived from Airman Leadership Qualities (ALQs) outlined in AFI 36-2406, *Officer and Enlisted Evaluations Systems*. Although CLQs are derived from the U.S. Air Force evaluation system, there is overlap and consideration given to the U.S. Space Force values of Character, Connection, Commitment, and Courage outlined in Space Force Handbook 1-1, *Guardian Spirit.* The MPA process is intended to be a developmental program for cadets and also serves as a mechanism to assess each cadet's proficiency in the skills, knowledge, and abilities required of them in their respective stage of development.

1.1.3. The MPA process runs over the course of an Academic semester during the normal cadet Academic Year (AY), and throughout the summer leadership programs. All MPA components will make up a portion of a 2000-point scale, as depicted in **Attachment 3**. At the end of the semester, the total number of points will be converted to a 4.00 rating system. The 4.00 rating system corresponds to the Grade Point Average (GPA) model and is used to give consistency to the MPAs. Cadets in good standing will be assigned a final MPA based on their class year along a forced distribution between 2.00 and 4.00 with only the top third of cadets per class year falling above a 3.00. Overall semester MPA values become part of each cadet's permanent cadet record of performance and represent the military component of each cadet's Overall Performance Average (OPA).

1.1.4. All 4-year USAFA enrolled cadets will earn an MPA each semester.

1.1.4.1. USAFA cadets that are away from USAFA on exchange programs will receive their cumulative MPA from the last semester they earned a semester MPA.

1.1.5. Commandant's List. The Commandant's List is reserved for cadets in good standing, that achieve an overall semester 3.0 MPA or higher, after the forced distribution described in **paragraph 1.1.3**. They will retain this status until the end of the next Academic semester IAW USAFAI 36-3510, *USAF Academy Cadet Program Recognizing Cadet Achievement*, (see exceptions in USAFAI 36-3523, *Review and Disposition of Deficient Cadets*, Para 1.1.1. and USAFAI 36-3510, *USAF Academy Cadet Program Recognizing Cadet Achievement*, Para 4.1..).

1.1.5.1. USAFA cadets that are away from USAFA on exchange programs do not qualify for the Commandant's List for the semester they were away.

2. General Roles and Responsibilities.

2.1. Leadership Roles and Responsibilities

2.1.1. Commandant of Cadets. Establish requirements for the MPA System and ensure all USAFA Major Units (MUs) understand and support the MPA program. Serves as the rater, primary mentor, and completes the CW Performance Assessment in its entirety (all sections of USAFA Form 715A) for the Cadet Wing Commander. Additionally, they complete the Permanent Party (PP) Performance Assessment for all cadets assigned to authorized Cadet Wing Staff positions, as defined in the Air Force Cadet Wing Classification Directory (AFCWCD). The Commandant may delegate the rating of all cadets assigned to Wing Staff positions, except for the Cadet Wing Commander, no lower than the CW Director of Operations.

2.1.2. PP Group Commander. Responsible for oversight and administration of the semester MPA process for cadets temporarily assigned to them each semester on their respective Cadet Group Staffs, as defined in the AFCWCD. The PP Group Commander completes the PP Commander portion of the CW Performance assessment for all cadets assigned to their respective authorized Cadet Group Staff positions each semester. PP Group Commanders can delegate these tasks no lower than the PP Group Deputy Commander.

2.1.3. PP Squadron Commander. Responsible for oversight and administration of the MPA process for cadets assigned to their squadron. PP Squadron Commanders complete the PP Commander portion of the CW Performance assessment for all cadets assigned to their authorized squadron positions each semester. PP Squadron Commander will have Blackboard accounts, and access to the MPA course each semester. PP Squadron Commander will mentor cadets through the Cadet Commander Assessments.

2.1.4. Academy Military Trainers (AMTs). Will have Blackboard accounts and access to the MPA course each semester. AMTs will ensure accuracy of the cadets MPA course enrollment within Blackboard. AMTs review performance assessments for all cadets assigned to their unit and enter performance averages into Blackboard. AMTs will mentor cadets through the Cadet Commander Performance Assessments and advise CW Squadron Commanders on MPA for all cadets assigned to their unit.

2.1.5. Cadet chain of command. Responsible for MPA program execution, including but not limited to, cadet supervisors providing initial and mid-term CCA feedbacks (USAFA Form 724, *Cadet Comprehensive Assessment),* and a final assessment (USAFA Form 715A *Cadet Performance Brief*) to each cadet whom they directly supervise, and a recommended final performance level to the Cadet Commanders.

2.1.5.1. All cadet raters throughout the process are required to be familiar with the CLQs so they may make informed ratings after long-term observations.

2.1.5.2. Cadet Commanders are responsible for leading the cadet chain of command through the MPA program execution. Cadet Commanders will consult the cadet chain of command before awarding Cadet Commander Performance Levels and performance averages.

2.2. **CW Staff Roles and Responsibilities**

2.2.1. CW Standardization & Evaluations (CWOV). Serves as the OPR for the MPA program. As the OPR, CWOV will:

2.2.1.1. Develop, publish, and execute the MPA timeline, aligning it with the USAFA master calendar. See **attachment 2** for the normal MPA timeline.

2.2.1.2. Develop and conduct required training for all PP raters and the Cadet Wing (CW) concerning the MPA process and procedures. CWOV will train MU representatives who will act as Points of Contact (POCs) and will be responsible for training their respective organizations.

2.2.1.3. Answer procedural or technical questions regarding MPA.

2.2.1.4. Lead the MPA Working Group.

2.2.1.5. Coordinate with Campus Solutions and Blackboard system managers to facilitate the MPA process.

2.2.1.6. Coordinate an MPA Review Committee (MPARC), chaired by the Vice Commandant of Cadets.

2.2.2. CW Development, Innovation, and Integration Division (CWX). Develop and implement a curriculum that equips the cadet chain of command with developmental coaching and feedback skills. Integrate the feedback and evaluation forms (USAFA Form 724, USAFA Form 715A *Cadet Performance Brief,* USAFA 715B, *External Cadet Performance Brief,* and CLQs into this training for cadets.

2.2.3. CW Training (CWT). Allocate sufficient time for cadets to implement MPA milestones located in **Attachment 2** into the Cadet Military Training Schedule (CMTS). Specifically, the CMTS must provide time for: initial and mid-term CCA, evaluations, PP Squadron Commanders review and certification, and final assessment debriefs between raters and subordinates.

2.3. **Other Roles and Responsibilities.**

2.3.1. Dean of Faculty (DF). DF instructors will assess cadet performance based on displayed CLQs prior to the end of the semester in accordance with the MPA timeline published by CWOV.

2.3.1.1. DF Department of Mathematics will aid CWOV in calculating the distribution curve described in **paragraph 1.1.3**.

2.3.2. Athletic Department (AD). Team Captains, Reconditioning Cadets in Charge (CIC), and AD personnel will assess cadet performance based on displayed CLQs for cadets on their official rosters prior to the end of the semester in accordance with the MPA timeline published by CWOV. The Executive Director of Athletic Programs, or designee, will validate all assessments.

2.3.3. 306 Flying Training Group (FTG). The 306 FTG personnel assess cadet performance based on displayed CLQs for cadets in advanced airmanship courses prior to the end of the semester in accordance with the MPA timeline published by CWOV.

2.3.4. Mission Support and Competitive Athletic Club Officers in Charge (OIC). Will assess the performance of all assigned CICs of their respective Mission Support and Competitive Athletic Clubs based on displayed CLQs. This requirement only applies to clubs designated as Mission Support of Competitive Athletic Clubs by CW/CWT. CW/CWT will validate the Club OICs final assessments.

2.3.5. HQ USAFA/LD, Center for Character and Leadership Development (CCLD). Review and make recommendations to revise the CLQs described in **Attachment 4** of this instruction. Assess the structure of the CLQs for each class and evaluate the effectiveness of the MPA program in providing feedback and supporting the development of cadets into officers who are prepared to lead on day one of active-duty service. Serve as advisors to the MPA Working Group.

2.3.6. Other USAFA PP Not Listed Above. USAFA faculty and staff may provide input on cadet performance regarding MPA directly to the PP Squadron Commander or AMT, identifying the applicable CLQs observed.

2.3.7. All individuals that are providing a subjective rating, regardless of MU, are responsible for reading this instruction and understanding the intent of the MPA program. They must also be familiar with the CLQs, so they may make informed ratings after long-term observations.

2.3.8. Campus Solutions. Program managers shall work with the CWOV to ensure Campus Solutions effectively automates the MPA process as much as possible.

2.3.9. Blackboard. Will ensure effective automation of the MPA process across all integrated IT programs.

3. MPA Components.

3.1. **Semester MPA.** Is composed of subjective and objective components. The weighting of subjective and objective components varies by class year as reflected in **Attachment 3**.

3.2. **Objective Components.** Is a quantitative assessment of cadet performance, which gives cadets direct control over a portion of their MPA. There are individual and group objective components.

3.2.1. Individual Objective Components.

3.2.1.1. Personal Appearance Inspection (PAI). Cadet graders conduct PAIs using AFCW Form 304 for grading criteria. Cadets receive an average of all required PAIs over the course of a semester.

3.2.1.2. Ante Meridiem Inspection (AMI). Cadet graders conduct AMIs using AFCW Form 300 for grading criteria. Cadets receive an average of all required AMIs over the course of a semester.

3.2.1.3. Saturday Ante Meridiem Inspection (SAMI). Cadet graders conduct SAMIs using AFCW Form 301 for grading criteria. Cadets receive an average of all required SAMIs over the course of a semester.

3.2.1.4. Commissioning Education (CE). CWX is responsible for Commissioning Education course-related scores and delivers the 'final' semester score to CWOV.

3.2.1.4.1. The CE score is only applied to the Spring Semester, regardless of the semester in which the cadet completed CE. This keeps the weights and components consistent across all the cadets of a class year.

3.2.1.4.1.1. **Exception.** The End of Course Basic Training Test score will be used as the Fall CE score for 4-degree cadets. The End of Course Basic Training Test fulfills some CE Requirements.

3.2.1.5. Knowledge Tests. Evaluate a cadet's understanding of standards outlined in AFCWI 36-3501, *Cadet Standards and Duties*, training outlined the Cadet Military Education and Training Plan (CMETP), and/or any topics directed by the Commandant. Knowledge Tests are administered to all four classes.

3.2.2. Group Objective Components.

3.2.2.1. Major Assessment Event (MAE). Assesses group performance. Each cadet will receive points based on their unit score for the Fall culminating exercise in the Fall semester and the Crucible event for the Spring semester.

3.2.2.1.1. If more than one MAE occurs in a semester, an average of the two scores will be used.

3.2.2.1.2. If makeup events are required due to substandard performance, the initial score will be used to calculate this component in MPA.

3.2.2.2. Squadron Objective Score Averages. Consists of unit AMI, SAMI, PAI, and Knowledge Tests averages. Only first and second degrees are assessed against this average and how well their unit performs on these objective components.

3.2.2.3. Cadets on Wing and Group Staff will receive their academic year unit's score for Group Objective Components.

3.3. **Subjective Components.** Is a qualitative assessment evaluating a cadet's duty performance.

3.3.1. Performance Assessment. Completed by the cadet chain of command, CW chain of command, and other Major Units where cadet performance is compared directly to their peers through an assigned performance average percentage between 0-100 based on their displayed CLQs.

3.3.1.1. Cadet Wing Performance Assessment is comprised of two separate assessments, the Cadet Commander Performance Assessment and the PP Performance Assessment. These two assessments are performed administratively as one through the USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Brief*.

3.3.1.1.1. Cadet Commander Performance Assessment is an assigned controlled performance average by class year and unit, based on a selected performance level of CLQs by the cadet chain of command for that reporting period.

3.3.1.1.1.1. The performance levels are a way to quantify and compare a cadet against their peers. The top performance levels are restricted to a controlled performance average to prevent inflation and ensure even distribution across the CW. The performance levels are:

3.3.1.1.1.1.1. Top 10% - restricted to the top 10% of cadets by unit and class year, rounded up to the nearest whole cadet. Cadets that receive this performance level will be awarded a 91% for their Cadet Commander assigned performance average.

3.3.1.1.1.1.2. Top 25% - restricted to the top 25% of cadets by unit and class year, rounded up to the nearest whole cadet. Cadets that receive this performance level will be awarded an 88% for their Cadet Commander assigned performance average.

3.3.1.1.1.1.3. Average - no restrictions by class year or unit. Cadets that receive this performance level will be awarded an 84% for their Cadet Commander assigned performance average.

3.3.1.1.1.1.4. Below Average - no restrictions by class year or unit. The cadet chain of command should consider using this performance level for the bottom 10% of a class year by unit. Cadets that receive this performance level will be awarded a 78% for their Cadet Commander assigned performance average.

3.3.1.1.1.1.5. Does not meet standards - no restrictions by class year or unit. Cadets that receive this performance level will be awarded a 69% for their Cadet Commander assigned performance average. Selection of this performance level will initiate a Squadron Commander Review Board for Probation Placement consideration.

3.3.1.1.1.2. Cadet Squadron Commanders will be assessed by Cadet Group Commanders. Cadet Squadron Commanders' performance levels will be controlled against the other Cadet Squadron Commanders in their Group and the Cadet Group Staff.

3.3.1.1.1.3. Cadet Group Commander will be assessed by the Cadet Wing Commander. Cadet Group Commanders' performance levels will be controlled against the other Cadet Group Commanders and the Cadet Wing Staff.

3.3.1.1.1.4. The Cadet Wing Commander will be assessed by the Commandant of Cadets IAW **paragraph 2.1.1**. There is no controlled average for the Commandant's assessment of the Cadet Wing Commander.

3.3.1.1.1.5. CW personnel will mentor cadets through the Cadet Commander Performance Assessment, but they should refrain from forcing adjustments. The intent of the Cadet Commander Performance Assessment is to remain independent of the PP Performance Assessment. PP Commanders should adjust their own assessments to reflect poor decisions of the Cadet Commanders.

3.3.1.1.2. PP Performance Assessment. Is an assigned controlled performance average by class year and unit, based on displayed CLQs by the Cadets' PP Commander for that reporting period.

3.3.1.1.2.1. The PP Commander will assign a performance level described in **para 3.3.1.1.1.1** above, but performance levels assigned by PP are not tied to a specific performance average.

3.3.1.1.2.2. PP Commanders will assign a performance average using the following controls:

3.3.1.1.2.2.1. Squadron performance averages must average out to a controlled average of 84% by class year.

3.3.1.1.2.2.2. Controlled averages may be adjusted based on the Commandant's performance incentives outlined in AFCWI 36-2809, *Outstanding Squadron System*.

3.3.1.1.2.2.3. Group Staff performance averages must average out to a controlled average of 88% by class year.

3.3.1.1.2.2.4. Wing Staff performance averages must average out to a controlled average of 91% by class year.

3.3.1.1.2.3. For the Permeant Party Performance Assessment, Cadet Squadron Commanders will be assessed by PP Squadron Commanders, Cadet Group Commanders will be assessed by PP Group Commanders, and the Cadet Wing Commander will be assessed by the Commandant of Cadets or their delegated authority.

3.3.1.2. DF Performance Assessment. Is an assigned performance average by DF instructors based on displayed CLQs. The assessment is worth 200 points towards a cadet's MPA. DF will aim to provide an assessment for all cadets that are required to be assigned an MPA.

3.3.1.2.1. Multiple performance assessments by DF personnel for a single cadet will be averaged into one score.

3.3.1.2.2. DF will provide final assessments to CWOV prior to CWOV deadlines.

3.3.1.3. Athletic Department (AD) Performance Assessment. Only cadets on official rosters will receive this assessment. The assessment is worth 200 points towards a cadet's MPA. The Athletic Department will provide a percentage score using a controlled performance average of no more than 86% by class year. Cadets will be assessed on their displayed CLQs. Team Captains will be assessed on their displayed CLQs in the performance of their duties outlined in the AFCWCD.

3.3.1.3.1. Team Captains will assess cadets on their teams and provide recommended performance averages to Team Coaches.

3.3.1.3.2. Team Coaches will adjust the team captains' recommendations as they deem professionally necessary.

3.3.1.3.3. The Executive Director of Athletic Programs, or designee, will validate all final performance assessments to ensure they meet institutional goals and controlled averages.

3.3.1.3.4. The Athletic Department will provide the final performance assessment averages to CWOV prior to CWOV deadlines.

3.3.1.4. 306 Flying Training Group (FTG) Performance Assessment. Only cadets in advanced airmanship courses will receive this assessment. The assessment is worth 200 points towards a cadet's MPA. The 306 FTG will assign a percentage based on displayed CLQs using a controlled performance average of no more than 88%. If a cadet is removed from the advanced airmanship course at any time no airfield performance assessment input will be applied.

3.3.1.4.1. The 306 FTG cadet chain of command will assess advanced airmanship cadets using the USAFA Form 715B and provide a recommended performance average to the 306 FTG Squadron Commanders.

3.3.1.4.2. The 306 FTG Squadron Commanders will adjust the recommendations as they deem professionally necessary using the USAFA Form 715B and will validate that the assessments meet institutional goals, controlled averages, and ensure 715Bs are distributed to the cadets Academic Year Squadrons.

3.3.1.4.3. The 306 FTG will provide the final performance assessments averages to CWOV prior to CWOV deadlines.

3.3.1.5. Mission Support and Competitive Athletic Club Performance Assessment. The Mission Support and Competitive Athletic Club OIC will assess all assigned Cadets in Charge (CIC) of their respective clubs. The assessment will be a percentage score using a controlled performance average of 91%. The assessment is worth 200 points towards a cadet's MPA. Cadets in Charge will be assessed on their CLQs displayed in the performance of their duties as outlined in the AFCWCD.

3.3.1.5.1. OICs will submit their professional assessments using the USAFA Form 715B. OICs will submit their final performance averages to CWT who will validate that the assessments meet institutional goals, controlled averages, and ensure USAFA 715Bs are distributed to the cadets Academic Year Squadrons.

3.3.1.5.1.1. OICs are encouraged to submit input on the performance of all other cadets on their rosters directly to the cadet's academic year PP Squadron Commander using the USAFA Form 715B, *External Cadet Performance Brief*. For non-CIC USAFA 715Bs, the assessment is only a recommendation for the PP Commander's consideration.

3.3.1.5.2. CWT will provide the final performance averages to CWOV prior to CWOV deadlines.

3.3.1.6. MUs may elect to have their allotted 200 points be reallocated to CW Performance Assessment for cadets with unique circumstances, as long as the owning PP Commander approves and agrees it is the best way to reflect the cadet's performance. PP Squadron Commanders will provide CWOV with the list of affected cadets, per CWOV published deadlines.

3.3.1.7. If a cadet qualifies for an assessment from more than one of the following; AD, 306 FTG, or a Mission Support and Competitive Athletic Club, an average of all assessments will be used.

3.3.1.8. If a cadet does not receive an assessment external to CW, the CW performance average will be used for all other assessments.

3.3.1.9. No blanket performance assessment averages will be used. Example: All cadets in a class year, program, or peer group receive an 84%.

4. USAFA Forms and Adminstrative Processes.

4.1. **USAFA Form 724*, Cadet Comprehensive Assessment Worksheet.*** Is used to document formal communication and feedback sessions, herein referred to as Cadet Comprehensive Assessment (CCA) sessions, regarding expectations and assessment of a cadet's displayed CLQs. Significant deviations from standards should be recorded in other administrative forms. (i.e., Letter of Reprimand, Letter of Admonishment, Letter of Counseling, MFR, USAFA Form 10, *Receipt for Keys*). At a minimum, every cadet will have an initial and mid-term CCA session documented on an USAFA Form 724.

4.1.1. USAFA Form 724 and CCA sessions are required for all cadets at USAFA during the reporting period.

4.1.1.1. CW Commanders can make exceptions for cadets that are patients, prisoners, on administrative turn-back, or other circumstances that make CCA sessions impractical.

4.1.2. CCA sessions will be conducted face-to-face. Exception: Raters may conduct sessions by telephone only in circumstances where face-to-face sessions are impractical and the CCA session cannot be conducted in a reasonable timeline.

4.1.3. CCA sessions will be conducted during allocated military training time identified on CMTS or as directed by the PP Commander.

4.1.4. Responsibilities.

4.1.4.1. The ratee will:

4.1.4.1.1. Know when CCA sessions are due.

4.1.4.1.2. Complete Section VI and sign the USAFA Form 724 indicating the date the rater conducted the CCA session.

4.1.4.2. The rater will:

4.1.4.2.1. Prepare for and conduct initial, mid-term, and ratee-requested CCA sessions. Ratee-requested CCA sessions will be accomplished within seven days of the ratee's request.

4.1.4.2.2. Understand and consider CLQs and CW standards when providing expectations or feedback during CCA sessions with the ratee.

4.1.4.2.3. Provide the original completed and signed USAFA Form 724 to the ratee.

4.1.4.2.4. Retain a copy of the signed and dated USAFA Form 724. The mid-term USAFA Form 724 is a required, mandatory supporting document to be routed with USAFA Form 715A *Cadet Performance Brief*, however, it will not be made a matter of the official record. In addition, the rater will retain a copy of the initial and mid-term USAFA Form 724 as this may be needed for any future appeals.

4.1.4.3. The cadet chain of command will:

4.1.4.3.1. Monitor personnel to ensure raters properly conduct CCA sessions.

4.1.4.3.2. Conduct CCA sessions when a lower-level rater is not available due to unusual circumstances, or officially assuming the subordinate rater's responsibilities.

4.1.4.4. The PP Commander will:

4.1.4.4.1. Administer the CCA process.

4.1.4.4.2. Consider disciplining raters and removing them from supervisory positions if they fail to conduct documented CCA sessions.

4.1.5. Preparing the USAFA Form 724.

4.1.5.1. USAFA Form 724 may be handwritten or typed by the rater providing the assessment.

4.1.5.2. Section I, Personal Information. Self-explanatory, fill in all required data.

4.1.5.3. Section II, Type of Assessment. In the appropriate box, indicate whether the assessment is initial, mid-term, ratee-requested, or rater-directed.

4.1.5.4. Section III, Job Description. Completed by the rater. This section is used to convey to the ratee their critical role in achieving mission success. Summarize the key duties from AFCWCD, AFCWI 36-3501, *Cadet Standards and Duties*, or CoCI 10-100, *Cadet Wing Summer Programs*, as applicable. For areas without a job description, provide the cadet with a clear explanation of their role and responsibilities.

4.1.5.5. Section IV, Major Performance Areas. Categories for CLQs. **Note:** See **Attachment 4** for a full description of each CLQ and the distinction between the Likert scale for rating proficiency. The rater places a mark in the appropriate block which indicates the ratee's level of performance.

4.1.5.5.1. Since the primary purpose of the initial CCA session is to establish expectations for the upcoming rating period, a rater is not expected to have already developed a clear-cut opinion of an individual's performance by the time the session is conducted. Therefore, raters will mark the "Initial" block in Section II, Type of Assessment, and will mark "Initial" in Section IV, Major Performance Areas, while discussing each area, and the performance expectations for the ratee in each area during the feedback session. It is helpful for the rater to clearly document their expectations in the comments section of each Major Performance Area.

4.1.5.5.2. For or all other CCA sessions, the rater will indicate how the ratee is meeting the established expectations by marking one block under each CLQ. These markings translate to an aggregate rating on the performance assessment and provide an indication of how the ratee is meeting the expectations set forth by the rater while providing the basis for the CCA session discussion. A good practice is to collect feedback from up and down the chain of command before providing feedback to the ratee, to see if there is anything of importance that the rater failed to observe. The rater should clearly document the ratee's performance by describing strengths, weaknesses, and improvement areas in the comments section of each Major Performance Area.

4.1.5.6. Section V, Additional Expectations. The rater may use this section to expand on expectations of any of the major performance areas.

4.1.5.7. Section VI, Knowing Your Airman/Guardian. Completed by the ratee. This area provides information to the rater on the ratee's goals, priorities, support system, and where they might need help. The rater should maintain awareness of how the ratee is doing in these areas throughout the reporting period and offer assistance, as required.

4.2. **USAFA Form 715A*, Cadet Performance Brief*.** Used to document displayed CLQs to compare cadet performance against their peers and assign a performance average. Every cadet that earns MPA will have a Final Performance Assessment documented on an USAFA Form 715A.

4.2.1. Responsibilities

4.2.1.1. The ratee will:

4.2.1.1.1. Sign Section VI of the USAFA Form 715A indicating the date the ratee received the final performance assessment.

4.2.1.2. The rater will:

4.2.1.2.1. Complete Sections I and II of the USAFA Form 715A.

4.2.1.2.2. Make a recommendation to the Cadet chain of command as to the performance level of their ratee.

4.2.1.2.3. Conduct a final face-to-face feedback with the ratee to review the final performance assessment.

4.2.1.3. The cadet chain of command will:

4.2.1.3.1. Assume the responsibilities of the rater when the rater is unable to complete the assessment.

4.2.1.3.2. Perform an administrative review of all evaluations in their rating chain, and if necessary, return them for correction or completion before sending them to the next level.

4.2.1.3.3. Make a recommendation to the Cadet Commander on the performance level of individual cadets in their rating chain.

4.2.1.4. The Cadet Commander will:

4.2.1.4.1. Make the final performance level determination on the USAFA Form 715A, based on the recommendations of the rater, cadet chain of command, and performance documented on the USAFA Form 715A.

4.2.1.5. AMTs will:

4.2.1.5.1. Perform a Quality Force Review of the Cadets discipline documents within Simplicity Advocate.

4.2.1.5.2. Check if the Cadet is on Conduct, Aptitude, or Honor probation. Cadets on probation will receive a 1.9 MPA for the semester the infraction occurred.

4.2.1.5.3. Review the USAFA Form 715As, *Cadet Performance Brief*, and Cadet Commander Performance Assessments to ensure compliance of controlled averages of performance ratings.

4.2.1.5.4. Advises the PP Commander on future roles and recommends a PP performance average for cadets.

4.2.1.5.5. Ensure completed USAFA 715As are uploaded into the cadet's electronic cadet personnel record (ECPR-II) in Simplicity Advocate.

4.2.1.6. The PP Commander will:

4.2.1.6.1. Review USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Briefs* and Cadet Commander Performance Assessments to ensure compliance of controlled averages of performance levels. PP Commanders will review and consider any received USAFA Form 715B, *External Cadet Performance Briefs*.

4.2.1.6.2. Select a performance level and assign a performance average for all cadets they are responsible for assigning an MPA, as defined in the AFCWCD.

4.2.1.6.3. Have the option to make additional comments on a cadet's performance, assessment of the ratees leadership, or officer potential.

4.2.1.6.4. Make comments on the USAFA Form 715A for Cadets on Honor, Aptitude, or Conduct Probation.

4.2.1.6.5. Have the option to recommend three future roles for the ratee to consider for their development at USAFA.

4.2.2. Preparing the USAFA Form 715A:

4.2.2.1. Section I. Ratee Identification Data. Fill in all required data. Name should be in upper case and listed as LAST, FIRST, M. Class Year and Rank should be listed as YYYY and CXC. Unit should be where the assessment occurs for that semester and listed as CS-XX, CGX or AFCW. Semester should be listed as Fall, Spring, and YYYY. Only Duty Titles listed in the AFCWCD will be used. Duty Descriptions should be written in complete sentences summarizing the key duties from AFCWCD, AFCWI 36- 3501, *Cadet Standards and Duties*, or CoCI 10-100, *Cadet Wing Summer Programs*, as applicable.

4.2.2.2. Section II. Cadet Rater Assessment. Capture 1-2 narrative statements in each Major Performance Area, considering applicable CLQs as outlined in **attachment 4**.

4.2.2.2.1. Narrative statements are standalone complete sentences, written in plain language, with at least 1 action and at least one impact or result/outcome.

4.2.2.2.2. Sub-sections 1-4 Major Performance Areas. The rater places a mark in the appropriate block which indicates the ratee's level of performance. **Note:** See **Attachment 4** for a full description of each CLQ and the distinction between the Likert scale for rating proficiency.

4.2.2.2.3. Sub-section 5. Cadet Rater Signature. Raters sign and provide their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in appropriate blocks.

4.2.2.3. Section III. Cadet Commander Performance Assessment.

4.2.2.3.1. Sub-section 1. Performance Level. Cadet Commander selects a performance level based on input from the rater and cadet chain of command for the cadet, adhering to controls outlined in **para 3.3.1.1.1.1**.

4.2.2.3.2. Sub-section 2. Cadet Commander Signature. Cadet Commanders sign and provide their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in appropriate blocks.

4.2.2.4. Section IV. AMT Review. AMT selects whether or not the cadet is on conduct, aptitude, or honor probation.

4.2.2.5. Section V. PP Commander Performance Assessment:

4.2.2.5.1. Sub-section 1. Performance Level. PP Commander selects a performance level based on input from the rater, cadet chain of command, and AMT for the cadet.

4.2.2.5.2. Sub-section 2. PP Commander Comments. PP Commander makes comments on the cadets performance, if desired.

4.2.2.5.2.1. Comments are mandatory for cadets on probation.

4.2.2.5.3. Sub-section 3. performance average. PP Commanders assign a performance average as a percentage grade from 0-100%, IAW controls in **para 3.3.1.1.2.2**.

4.2.2.5.4. Sub-Section 4. Future Roles. PP Commander makes recommendations for future roles the cadet should consider during their development at USAFA.

4.2.2.5.5. Sub-section 5. PP Commander Signature. PP Commanders sign and provide their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in appropriate blocks.

4.2.2.6. Section VI. Ratee Acknowledgement. Ratee signs and dates the form to acknowledge the final evaluation feedback was received.

4.3. **USAFA Form 715B, *External Cadet Performance Brief*.** Is the primary means to collect otherwise undocumented displayed CLQs from supervisors outside a cadet's rating chain of command for awarding Performance Assessment points.

4.3.1. Responsibilities.

4.3.1.1. The Ratee will:

4.3.1.1.1. Sign section V, Ratee Acknowledgement, on the USAFA Form 715B once the final performance feedback has been received.

4.3.1.2. The external rater will:

4.3.1.2.1. Complete sections I-III of the USAFA Form 715B

4.3.1.2.2. Submit the signed USAFA Form 715Bs to the cadets PP chain of command prior to the deadlines outlined in **attachment 2**.

4.3.1.2.2.1. The 306 FTG and Club OIC raters will provide the performance averages to CWOV through the process outlined in **paragraph 3**.

4.3.1.3. The AMT will:

4.3.1.3.1. Review the USAFA Form 715B prior to making a performance level and assigned performance average recommendation to the PP Commander.

4.3.1.3.2. Ensure ratee signed USAFA Form 715Bs are uploaded into the cadet's ECPR-II in Simplicity Advocate.

4.3.1.4. The PP Commander will:

4.3.1.4.1. Review the USAFA Form 715B prior to making a performance level and assigned performance average determination for the Cadet.

4.3.1.4.2. Ensure the Cadet receives feedback from the external rater.

4.3.2. Preparing the USAFA Form 715B:

4.3.2.1. Section I. Ratee Identification Data. Fill in all required data. Name should be in upper case and listed as LAST, FIRST, M. Class Year and Rank should be listed as YYYY and CXC. Unit should be where the assessment occurs for that semester and listed as CS-XX, CGX or AFCW. Semester should be listed as Fall, Spring, and YYYY. Only Duty Titles listed in the AFCWCD will be used. Duty Descriptions should be written in complete sentences summarizing the key duties from AFCWCD, AFCWI 36- 3501, *Cadet Standards and Duties*, or CoCI 10-100, *Cadet Wing Summer Programs*, as applicable.

4.3.2.2. Section II. External Rater Assessment.

4.3.2.2.1. Sub-sections 1-4 Major Performance Areas. The rater places a mark in the appropriate block which indicates the ratee's level of performance. **Note:** See **Attachment 4** for a full description of each CLQ and the distinction between the Likert scale for rating proficiency.

4.3.2.2.2. Sub-section 5. External Rater Comments. External raters may write 1-3 narrative statements that capture the ratee's performance and displayed CLQs.

4.3.2.2.2.1. Narrative statements are standalone complete sentences, written in plain language, with at least 1 action and at least one impact or result/outcome.

4.3.2.2.3. Sub-section 6. External Rater performance average. External Raters can make a recommendation to the PP Commander by assigning a performance average between 0-100%.

4.3.2.2.3.1. USAFA Form 715Bs completed as part of the Airfield or Club CIC assessments must have a performance average as a percentage grade from 0-100%, IAW controls in para **3.3.1.4 and 3.3.1.5**.

4.3.2.2.4. Sub-section 7. External Rater Performance Level Recommendation. External rater selects a performance level recommendation for PP Commander consideration.

4.3.2.3. Section III. External Rater Signature. Raters sign and provide their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in appropriate blocks.

4.3.2.4. Section IV. PP Commander Acknowledgement. PP Commander signs indicating the USAFA Form 715B has been reviewed.

4.3.2.5. Section V. Ratee Acknowledgement. Ratee signs and dates the form to acknowledge the final assessment feedback was received.

4.4. **USAFA Form 715C, Summer Program Cadet Performance Brief.** Is the primary means to collect and document displayed CLQs of C1Cs and C2Cs earning MPA during Summer Programs. USAFA Form 715Cs also provide a means of final performance feedback to the cadet and assist PP Summer Commanders in assigning a CW Performance Average for the summer period.

4.4.1. Responsibilities.

4.4.1.1. The ratee will:

4.4.1.1.1. Sign section V, Ratee Acknowledgement, on the USAFA Form 715C once the final performance feedback has been received.

4.4.1.2. The cadet summer rater will:

4.4.1.2.1. Complete sections I-III of the USAFA Form 715C

4.4.1.2.2. Submit the signed USAFA Form 715C to the summer programs cadets chain of command.

4.4.1.2.3. Conduct a final face-to-face feedback with the ratee to review the final performance assessment.

4.4.1.3. The cadet chain of command will:

4.4.1.3.1. Assume the responsibilities of the rater when the rater is unable to complete the assessment.

4.4.1.3.2. Perform an administrative review of all evaluations in their rating chain, and if necessary, return them for correction or completion before sending them to the next level.

4.4.1.4. The PP Summer Program Commander will:

4.4.1.4.1. Review the USAFA Form 715C prior to assigning a final performance average to the ratee.

4.4.1.4.2. Ensure the Cadet receives feedback from the cadet summer rater.

4.4.1.4.3. Ensure ratee signed USAFA Form 715Cs are provided to the ratees Academic Year Squadron Commander.

4.4.1.5. The Academic Year Squadron Commander will:

4.4.1.5.1. Ensure ratee signed USAFA Form 715Cs are uploaded into the cadet's ECPR-II in Simplicity Advocate.

4.4.2. Preparing the USAFA Form 715C:

4.4.2.1. Section I. Ratee Identification Data. Fill in all required data. Name should be in upper case and listed as LAST, FIRST, M. Class Year and Rank should be listed as YYYY and CXC. Summer Program should be the program where the assessment occurs for that semester. Summer period Semester should be listed as 1, 2, or 3 - YYYY. Duty Descriptions should be written in complete sentences.

4.4.2.2. Section II. Cadet Summer Rater Assessment.

4.4.2.2.1. Sub-sections 1-4 Major Performance Areas. The cadet summer rater places a mark in the appropriate block which indicates the ratee's level of performance. **Note:** See **Attachment 4** for a full description of each CLQ and the distinction between the Likert scale for rating proficiency.

4.4.2.2.2. Sub-section 5. Cadet Summer Rater Comments. Cadet summer raters may write 1-3 narrative statements that capture the ratee's performance and displayed CLQs.

4.4.2.2.2.1. Narrative statements are standalone complete sentences, written in plain language, with at least 1 action and at least one impact or result/outcome.

4.4.2.2.2.2. Comments are mandatory if "needs improvement" is selected in any of the sub-sections 1-4.

4.4.2.3. Section III. Cadet Summer Rater Signature. Cadet summer raters sign and provide their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in appropriate blocks.

4.4.2.4. Section IV. PP Summer Commander Performance Assessment:

4.4.2.4.1. Sub-section 1. PP Summer Commander Comments. PP Summer Commander's may write 1-3 narrative statements that capture the ratee's performance and displayed CLQs.

4.4.2.4.1.1. Comments are mandatory for cadets that are assigned a performance level below 70%.

4.4.2.4.2. Sub-section 2. PP Commander assigns a performance average between 0-100% based on the ratees displayed CLQs, signs, and provides their full name, grade, organization, duty title, and date in the appropriate blocks.

4.4.2.4.2.1. Assigned performance averages will follow the controls outlined in **paragraph 7** of this document.

4.4.2.5. Section V. Ratee Acknowledgement. Ratee signs and dates the form to acknowledge the final assessment feedback was received.

4.5. **Disposition and Access.**

4.5.1. USAFA Form 724.

4.5.1.1. USAFA Form 724s may not be reviewed by anyone other than the rater, ratee, and authorized personnel, specifically for the purposes of completing performance assessments on the USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Brief*. For cadets, the AMT, PP Squadron Commanders, PP Group Senior Enlisted Leader (SEL), CW Group Commander, CW Command Chief, Vice Commandant, and Commandant are authorized access to the USAFA Form 724 specifically for the purpose of reviewing performance assessments.

4.5.1.2. For cadets on Reserve Officers' Training Corps (ROTC), Service Academy, or Foreign Exchange, raters will conduct CCAs and complete USAFA Form 724; however, the USAFA Form 724 will not be sent to their home station rater. A memo may be sent to the home station rater if there are any issues the temporary rater wishes to address.

4.5.1.3. Units may establish procedures beyond those provided in this chapter to ensure CCA sessions are completed, provided those procedures do not violate the privacy of USAFA Form 724 communications.

4.5.2. USAFA Form 715A, 715B, and 715C.

4.5.2.1. AMTs, PP Squadron Commanders, PP Group Senior Enlisted Leader (SEL), CW Group Commander, CW Command Chief, Vice Commandant, and Commandant are authorized access to the USAFA Form 715As, 715Bs, and 715Cs for talent management and quality force decisions.

4.5.2.2. Completed USAFA 715As, 715Bs, and 715Cs are uploaded into the cadet's electronic cadet personnel record (ECPR-II) in Simplicity Advocate.

5. Deficiencies and Probation.

5.1. **A MPA score below 2.0 is considered substandard performance.** An MPA below 2.0 at the end of the semester will result in the cadet being placed on formal probation.

5.2. A performance level of "does not meet standards" assigned by the Cadet Commander or PP Commander on the USAFA Form 715A is an indicator of substandard performance. This initiates a Squadron Commander Review Board to determine if a cadet should be placed on conduct and/or aptitude probation.

5.3. A PP assigned performance average of less than 70 on the USAFA Form 715A is an indicator of substandard performance. This initiates a Squadron Commander Review Board to determine if a cadet should be placed on conduct and/or aptitude probation.

5.4. A cadet on conduct, aptitude, or honor probation will not receive a higher semester MPA than a 1.9 for the respective semester in which the infraction occurred Exception for the summer semester as outlined in **paragraph 7** of this document.

5.4.1. If administrative actions cannot be completed before MPA is due, PP Squadron Commanders will contact CWOV to manually correct the MPA within Campus Solutions.

5.4.2. Because the Final MPA will be a 1.9 for cadets on honor, conduct, or aptitude probation, PP and Cadet Commanders will assign a performance level, but are not required to select "does not meet standards." Cadets are assessed based on their current performance to ensure they are receiving actionable feedback.

5.4.3. Cadets on probation due not count towards PP Commander Assessment Controlled Averages.

5.4.3.1. If a PP Squadron Commander rates a cadet below 1.9 for two consecutive semesters due to probation, they must consult with the PP Group Commander.

6. Appeals and Corrections.

6.1. **Program Appeals.** MUs and all selected participants with direct input into MPA can appeal the results of their respective inputs, if the provided system is creating unfair results.

6.1.1. All program appeals will be submitted to CWOV, who will review and forward the request to the Vice Commandant. The final program appeal decision authority is the Vice Commandant.

6.1.2. At a minimum, appeals should include a DAF FORM 679 and a detailed explanation of the circumstances warranting review. Provide a breakdown of each cadet in the selected population, their cumulative average, the scores being awarded for that specific semester, and explanation regarding why the results are unfair.

6.1.3. If a MU is forced to appeal for two consecutive semesters due to the same root cause, the MPARC will consider amending this instruction to create a more lasting correction.

6.2. **Individual Appeals.** Throughout the MPA cycle, the appeal process ensures numerous safeguards to support the accuracy and fairness of the cadet ratings.

6.2.1. Objective scores should be resolved immediately. If the cadet does not agree with an "objective" score, the cadet has five duty days from the objective event to notify their chain of command. Exception: Cadets should route CE appeals to their CE instructor.

6.2.2. If a cadet has a basis for why his/her "subjective" evaluation is unwarranted, the cadet has five duty days following their primary rater's final feedback to compile the necessary paperwork for review and notify their PP chain of command.

6.2.3. Minimum Requirements. The following are the minimum requirements for review:

6.2.3.1. An MFR indicating the rating that is in question with documentation regarding specifically where the error occurred.

6.2.3.2. A summary report of all Semester Objective Scores/Inspections, if the appeal is regarding their objective rating.

6.2.3.3. The cadet will provide letters of recommendation from instructors, coaches or classmates, if the appeal is regarding their subjective rating.

6.2.4. PP Commander Response. The PP Commander will respond to the package and meet with the cadet within five duty days of package receipt. If the cadet's issues are not resolved in a meeting with the PP Squadron Commander, they may appeal to the PP Group Commander. The PP Group Commander is the final authority on individual appeals. CW Commanders are advised to use extreme caution in addressing an appeal via a manual override, as this inherently skews the established averages in each squadron and could affect Commandant's List placement and other systems that use the MPA (i.e., OPA, Graduation Order of Merit). In addition, such changes will impact other cadets' MPAs. If changes are made, CW Commanders will contact CWOV to ensure the MPA score is amended properly.

6.2.5. Corrections and appeals that occur after the Final MPA for the semester has been calculated and transferred to Campus Solutions require a manual update from CWOV and the Registrar (DFVR).

6.2.5.1. To minimize the impact to the forced distribution calculations, the correction or appeal will force a recalculation of the forced distribution, but only the cadet's MPA with correction or appeal will be updated. No other cadet's MPA or Honors lists will be adjusted.

6.2.5.2. If the corrected or appealed MPA qualifies for an honors list, they will be manually added.

7. Summer MPA.

7.1. **Purpose.** The purpose of summer MPA is to provide continuous developmental and evaluative feedback to the upper two classes throughout their summer programs. Summer MPA is weighted at 20% of the overall Academic Year MPA.

7.2. **Guidance.**

7.2.1. First and second-class cadets in leadership programs and select broadening programs will receive an MPA for each period during the summer.

7.2.2. CWT, when required, will determine and publish a list of programs receiving an MPA prior to the beginning of the first summer period. In general, any summer program approved to earn leadership credit for participating cadets will require an MPA to be entered to aid in documenting satisfactory performance of a cadet's leadership duties.

7.2.3. Summer MPA is calculated using the CW Professional Assessment component. The CW Performance Assessment is awarded using a performance average percentage from 0-100. Due to the reduced timeline of summer programs, only the Permanent Party Commander Assessment and performance averages will be used.

7.2.3.1. Squadrons' performance averages are controlled to an 84% average by program and class year.

7.2.3.2. Groups performance averages are controlled to an 88% average by program and class year.

7.2.3.3. The Wings performance averages are controlled to a 91% average by program and class year.

7.2.4. The PP summer program Group Commander designates each programs Unit Manning Structure such as which programs and cadets are Group and Squadron Staff.

7.2.5. A performance average of less than 70% is considered to be deficient for the assessment period and will be communicated to the Academic Year PP Squadron Commander. This will initiate a SCRB for the Academic Year Cadet chain of command to consider the cadet for conduct and/or aptitude probation.

7.2.6. Cadets placed on probation during the summer semester can earn an MPA of 2.0 and above during the summer semester, however, they will receive the deficient MPA of 1.9 in the following Fall Semester.

7.2.7. Additional components and weights must be approved by CWT.

7.2.8. Cadets will receive a separate assessment for each summer period in which they participate in an identified program. Cadets that are in more than one MPA qualifying program, will receive an average of each program's assessment to calculate their overall summer MPA.

7.2.9. During each summer period, each cadet rater will provide at least one initial CCA feedback using the USAFA Form 724 and one final assessment using the USAFA Form 715C for cadets earning MPA in a summer program.

7.2.9.1. PP summer program Group Commanders may develop alternative means of assessing cadet performance instead of using the USAFA Form 715C, but cadets will be assessed on their displayed CLQs and will be assigned a performance average.

7.2.10. Performance averages are entered into Blackboard by the PP summer program's Squadron Commanders and/or AMTs, program leads/instructors, along with other PP course graders NLT two business days prior to the end of each period.

7.2.11. If a cadet does not complete a summer program that receives an MPA, their cumulative MPA from the Spring semester will be their final summer MPA.

7.2.12. All cadets need to review their records in Blackboard during the summer period transitions to ensure all grades are accounted for and accurate. If they are not, the cadet should begin the appeal process outlined in **paragraph 6** of this instruction.

7.2.12.1. Appeals are conducted in the same manner as the AY process outlined in **paragraph 6** of this instruction, however, the appeal authority is the PP summer program's Squadron Commander or Officer equivalent and the PP summer program's Group Commander.

7.2.12.2. All appeal requests must be made within 5 days to the cadet's program chain of command due to the expedited timeline of summer MPA.

7.2.13. At the end of the summer, all cadets that earned an MPA through a summer program will have their performance averages converted to a 4.00 rating system. The 4.00 rating system corresponds to the Grade Point Average (GPA) model and is used to give consistency to the MPAs. Cadets will be assigned a final MPA based on their class year along a forced distribution between 2.00 and 4.00 with only the top third of cadets per class year falling above a 3.00. The overall summer MPA values become part of each cadet's permanent cadet record of performance.

8. Program Oversight and Assessment.

8.1. **MPA Review Committee.** The MPARC is chaired by the Vice Commandant, and it will meet a minimum of once per semester to discuss the process, data, trends, and other related topics for program sustainment and improvement. This committee will also review all recommended changes to the MPA program and its recommendations will be forwarded to the Commandant for final decision. This committee is tied to the USAFA corporate process.

8.1.1. Composition. Members will include, but are not limited to: two of the four PP Group Commanders , two PP Squadron Commanders (mix of one 1st-year and one 2nd-year PP Squadron Commander; not already MPA Working Group members), a CWX and CWT representative, an AD representative, a DF representative, the USAFA Airmanship Program Manager (representing 306 FTG), CWOV, a CCLD representative, a Blackboard representative, and Campus Solutions Program Management Office (PMO) representative. MPARC members are expected to inform CWOV if they can no longer serve on the committee. CWOV is responsible for establishing the meeting dates, agenda, and for maintaining a current list of committee members.

8.1.2. Meeting Schedule. The MPARC will meet once per academic semester, prior to or shortly after Prog, excluding the summer.

8.1.3. Meeting Deliverables. A minimum of one week before the meeting, CWOV will forward the upcoming agenda along with any associated reports, MPA change recommendations, and assessment data to each of the board members. CWOV will record the meeting and generate minutes within three duty days following the meeting. Additionally, the MPARC will review any program appeal requests and forward its program adjustment recommendations to the Vice Commandant for a final decision. CWOV will prepare board recommendations and decisions for the Vice Commandant's review and final decision.

8.1.4. MU Representation. The MPARC members will be the primary interface between their represented group (to include MUs), and CW with regards to the MPA system. This will ensure two-way communication flow, both to and from CW in terms of MU questions, concerns, and recommendations. This aspect of the MPARC is vital to program sustainment.

8.2. **MPA Working Group.** The MPA Working Group (MWG), chaired by CWOV, will address systemic issues as they arise and gather input from the cadet wing (cadets and PP).

8.2.1. Composition. Members will include four PP Squadron Commanders (two 1st-year; two 2nd-year), four AMTs (one per group), one C1C from each Group (nominated by Group Commanders), and representative from each MU/CW Division that assigns performance assessment points towards MPA. CWOV will serve as the chairperson. The Behavioral Sciences and Leadership Department will serve as an advisor to the team, as needed. HQ USAFA/CCLD will serve as an advisor to the team, in an institutional integrator role and program assessment role . MWG members are expected to inform CWOV if they can no longer participate in the working group. CWOV is responsible for establishing the meeting dates, agenda, and for maintaining a current list of working group members.

8.2.2. Meeting Schedule. The MWG will meet a minimum of twice per academic semester. During the academic semester, the MWG will meet once to review the Prog results, primarily to ensure score validity and prevent inflation. The MWG will meet again at the end of the semester to ensure score validity, prevent inflation, and correct any major errors prior to the scores becoming finalized.

8.2.3. Meeting Deliverables. A minimum of one week before the meeting CWOV will forward the upcoming agenda along with any associated reports, MPA change recommendations, and assessment data to each of the board members. CWOV will record the meeting and generate minutes within three duty days following the meeting. CWOV will prepare board recommendations and decisions for MPARC review and recommendation.

8.2.4. MWG Recommendations. MWG recommendations will be reviewed and discussed by the MPARC prior to being submitted to the Commandant for final decision.

8.3. **Routine Process Review.** Routine process reviews are an essential aspect of the system's validity, health, and sustainment. Routine process reviews will be conducted at every level, and the responses will be aggregated in the MWG for review and further assessment by the MPARC. At a minimum, routine process reviews will be collected and documented twice per AY. The results from review will be compiled into a report. Once the report has been reviewed by the MWG and the MPARC, CWOV will maintain the report within the MPA historical records.

8.3.1. Mid-Semester. The main purpose of the Mid-Semester review is to review the mid-semester results to prevent inflation and ensure score validity. The MWG is responsible for compiling the results, addressing any issues that require immediate attention, and including the results in the End-of-Semester Review.

8.3.2. End-of-Semester Review. The primary purpose of the End-of-Semester Review is to ensure score validity, prevent inflation, and correct any major errors prior to the scores becoming finalized. Once the scores are finalized, the results will be combined with the mid-semester review in the form of an End-of-Semester report.

8.3.3. Routine Reports. At a minimum the MWG will pull the following reports for review and inclusion in the End-of-Semester Review:

8.3.3.1. An average of all objective scores by squadron (includes group and wing staff);

8.3.3.2. A performance assessment average by squadron (includes group and wing staff);

8.3.3.3. A performance assessment average from each MU, broken down by program and/or instructor, as appropriate;

8.3.3.4. A report of missing scores with associated program and/or instructor identified;

8.3.3.5. A report of the overall MPA average on the 4.0 scale (to monitor possible inflation).

8.3.4. Irregularities (such as inflated grades) must be identified, and the point of input (specific program and/or instructor) should be provided with an opportunity to justify or correct the irregularity.

8.3.5. CWOV is the primary OPR for addressing grading errors and irregularities.

8.3.6. Non-standard Reports. Non-standard reports should be run for all instances of possible invalid and/or unfair results within the MPA system. CWOV, with the assistance of the Campus Solutions PMO and Blackboard PMO, is the primary OPR for running non-standard reports.

8.4. **Program Assessment.** An MPA program assessment will be conducted by CCLD/LDR . LDR will collect, aggregate, and report upon data that will provide relevant insight into MPA at a biannual frequency. At a minimum, the following success criteria will be utilized and refined throughout the assessment cycle:

8.4.1. Was cadet performance adequately captured through the feedback and evaluation system?

8.4.2. What areas were not adequately captured and how can we improve the assessment?

8.4.3. Did PP Squadron Commanders and/or AMTs administer the MPA process as intended?

8.4.4. Did the feedback and evaluation system encourage and reinforce the behaviors we desire from our cadets?

8.4.5. Are cadets being provided with adequate feedback on their progress toward desired behaviors?

8.5. **Program Changes.** All guidance in this instruction is empirical. To change any and/or all components of MPA, including the attachments, will require an update to this instruction in advance of the change. This requirement is intended to stabilize the score by slowing the rate of change and prevent unintended consequences of well-intended input, through a deliberate and thoroughly vetted review process.

8.5.1. To change this instruction, the requestor must first petition CWOV with a change request. This can be accomplished with an MFR. CWOV will refer to the historical documentation and provide the petitioner with additional information regarding the rationale behind the current construct. If the petitioner is not satisfied with the response, or there is insufficient rationale, the petitioner will submit a change request, via a DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*.

8.5.2. Changes to this instruction will be submitted via a DAF Form 847. The DAF Form 847 and all supporting documentation will be reviewed and commented on by the MWG. The MWG's recommendations will be presented to the next scheduled MPARC. The MPARC will make a recommendation to adopt, modify, or deny the change request, which will be validated by the Commandant. Once the Commandant has made a decision, CWOV will include the results in the MPA historical records, then inform the petitioner of the results.

8.5.3. Once a change request is approved, CWOV will update this instruction. Minor changes can be documented as a Guidance Memo or as an interim change (Change 1, Change 2, etc.). Wholesale changes, major revisions, and accumulated minor changes will result in a republication. None of the changes, minor or major, will take effect until the changed publication (rewritten & certified, incorporating changes from an interim change, or with the attached Guidance Memo) is updated, signed, and published.

8.6. **Historical Documentation.** MPA has undergone numerous substantive changes and receives criticism for seemingly being in a constant state of change. Many of the aspects of the current system were part of a past system, then brought back after careful study (ex: summer MPA, and direct MU input into MPA). Historical documentation is vital to create stability and maintain a healthy program. CWOV maintains historical documentation for the MPA system. Before a program change is voted on, the MPARC will review all historical references to the component in question. Wholesale changes are discouraged unless they are determined to be essential to effective evaluation of cadet performance. Any changes to this instruction and the MPA system must be documented and included in CW's annual historical report. Although not all-inclusive, at a minimum the following will be included in the MPA historical records:

8.6.1. All end-of-semester reports.

8.6.2. All assessment reports, provided by CCLD/LDR.

8.6.3. All change requests and their documented outcome.

8.6.4. All previous versions of USAFAI 36-2401, *Military Performance Appraisal*.

TONY D. BAUERNFEIND
Lieutenant General, USAF
Superintendent

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* 22 March 2020

AFI 36-2406, *Officer and Enlisted Evaluations Systems*, 06 Aug 24

DAFI 36-2614, *Pre-Commissioning Education and Training Program*, 07 Oct 22

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures,* 25 Mar 2022

DAFPD 36-24, *Military Evaluations*, 6 Oct 2022

USAFAI 36-3510, *USAF Academy Cadet Program Recognizing Cadet Achievement,* 18 Oct 18

USAFAI 36-3523, *Review and Disposition of Deficient Cadets*, 06 Dec 18

Prescribed Forms

USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Brief*

USAFA 715B, *External Cadet Performance Brief*

USAFA 715C, *Summer Program Cadet Performance Brief*

USAFA 724, *Cadet Comprehensive Assessment*

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

USAFA Form 10, *Receipt for Keys*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AD—Athletic Department

AFCW—Air Force Cadet Wing

AFCWCD—Air Force Cadet Wing Classification Directory

AFCWI—Air Force Cadet Wing Instruction

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AMI—Ante Meridiem Inspection

AMT—Academy Military Trainer

AY—Academic Year

CCA—Cadet Comprehensive Assessment

CCLD—Center for Character and Leadership Development

CE—Commissioning Education

CIC—Cadet In Charge

CLQ—Cadet Leadership Quality

CMETP—Cadet Military and Education Training Plan

CMTS—Cadet Military Training Schedule

CoCI—Commandant of Cadet Instruction

CW—Cadet Wing

CWOV—CW Standards & Evaluations

CWT—CW Training and Support Division

CWX—CW Development, Innovation, and Integration Division

C1C—Cadet 1st Class

C2C—Cadet 2nd Class

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DF—Dean of Faculty

DFVR—DF Registrar

DNIF—Duties Not to Include Flying

ECPR-II—Electronic Cadet Personnel Record - Two

FTG—Flying Training Group

GPA—Grade Point Average

IAW—In Accordance With

IT—Information Technology

MAE—Major Assessment Event

MFR—Memorandum for Record

MPA—Military Performance Appraisal

MPARC—MPA Review Committee

MU—Major Unit

MWG—MPA Working Group

NLT—No Later Than

OIC—Officer in Charge

OPA—Overall Performance Average

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PAI—Personal Appearance Inspection

PMO—Program Management Office

POC—Point of Contact

PP—Permanent Party

ROTC—Reserve Officers’ Training Corps

SAMI—Saturday Ante Meridiem Inspection

SCRB—Squadron Commander Review Board

SEL—Senior Enlisted Leader

USAFA—United States Air Force Academy

Terms

Blackboard—Web based learning management system used for course management, assessment and grading.

Campus Solutions—A student information system used to maintain student academic records and other functions.

FalconNet—Web based application used by cadets to conduct and record inspections along with other functions.

Simplicity Advocate—A case management platform used to store cadets' personnel records such as Cadet Performance Briefs and discipline paperwork.

Attachment 2

MPA TIMELINE GUIDE

Table A2.1. MPA Timeline.

Academic Start Date	**Fall and Spring Semester Milestones****	**Academic Due Date**
M1-2	**Milestones identified in this chart are for a generic semester and are to be used as a guideline; some days may be adjusted based on mission changes or USAFA related events that may conflict.	M1- 2
M2	**Initial feedback period commences (Use USAFA Form 724, *Cadet Comprehensive Assessment*)**	M5
T4	**PP Squadron Commanders and/or AMTs validate cadet rosters in Blackboard**	M7
M16	**Mid-semester feedback period commences (Use USAFA Form 724, *Cadet Comprehensive Assessment*)**	M18
T28	**Cadet Supervisors assess ratees using USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Brief* to begin Cadet Commander Performance Assessment.**	M30
T28	**USAFA Form 715B, *External Cadet Performance Briefs* due to PP Squadron Commander**	M31
T29	**Cadet Chain of Command assesses cadet performance and provides a recommendation to Cadet Commanders.**	M32
M32	**Cadet commanders make final performance level determination and submits to PP Commander for PP Performance Assessment.**	T34
M34	**Dean of Faculty, Athletic Department, Mission Support & Competitive Athletic Club CIC, & Airfield Inputs due to CWOV**	T34
T34	**PP Squadron Commander and/or AMT reviews USAFA Form 715A, *Cadet Performance Brief*, 715B, *External Cadet Performance Briefs*, validates probations, & assigns final averages and makes inputs into Blackboard.**	M37
T36	**PP Squadron Commander and/or AMT Completes Assessment Period (Use USAFA Form 715A *Cadet Performance Brief*, to provide face-to-face feedback to subordinates, obtain signatures on final assessments)**	M39
T36	CWOV ensures all objective scores have been entered in Blackboard	T37
T37	**All subjective scores must be submitted**	T37
T37	CWOV calculates semester MPAs and loads in Blackboard	M38
T38	**Subjective MPA appeals**	T40 +3
T40	MPAs closed; CWOV finalizes MPAs for Campus Solutions grade migration	T40 +5
Note: Plain text denotes CWOV duty, bold, indicates duties which belong to squadrons, raters, and ratees.		

Attachment 3

MPA POINT DISTRIBUTION

Table A3.1. MPA Point Distribution.

MPA Point Distribution

	CW, DF and AD/AF/Club Inputs	Firstie	2 deg	3deg	4 deg
		Points	Points	Points	Points
	Cadet Commander Performance Assessment	50	75	100	100
	Permenent Party Performance Assessment	450	425	300	300
CW's Input	**CW Performance Assessment (Total)**	500	500	400	400
CW's Input	Major Assessment Events	200	175	150	75
CW's Input	Squadron Obj Average (AMI, SAMI, PAI, K-tests)	225	175		
CW's Input	PAI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	SAMI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	AMI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	Knowledge Tests	150	150	150	150
CW's Input	Commissioning Education (Spring Semester Only)	300	300	300	300
External	DF Performance Assessment	200	200	200	200
External	AD/Airfield/Club CIC Performance Assessment	200	200	200	200
	MPA Point Totals:	2000	2000	2000	2000

	CW and DF-Only Inputs	Firstie	2 deg	3deg	4 deg
		Points	Points	Points	Points
	Cadet Commander Performance Assessment	50	75	100	100
	Permenent Party Performance Assessment	650	525	500	500
CW's Input	**CW Perfromance Assessment**	700	700	600	600
CW's Input	Major Assessment Events	200	175	150	75
CW's Input	Squadron Obj Average (AMI, SAMI, PAI, K-tests)	225	175		
CW's Input	PAI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	SAMI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	AMI	75	100	200	225
CW's Input	Cadet Core Tasks & Knowledge	150	150	150	150
CW's Input	Commissioning Education (Spring Semester Only)	300	300	300	300
External	DF Performance Assessment	200	200	200	200
	MPA Point Totals:	2000	2000	2000	2000

Attachment 4

MPA CADET LEADERSHIP QUALITIES

A4.1. Cadet Leadership Qualities (CLQ). Performance feedback and evaluations are measured upon 10 desired CLQs. These CLQs represent the performance characteristics we want to define, develop, incentivize, and measure in our Cadets with increasing the clarity and effectiveness of feedback. The CLQs fall under four Major Performance Areas. Taken together, this system develops mission-focused Cadets, while reinforcing the development of useful traits and behaviors our Air Force values by emphasizing Cadets' character and competence, along with successful outcomes and behaviors. The descriptions and behaviors of the CLQs and Major Performance Areas detailed in Section A4.3 are built on the foundation of our Air Force Core Values and tied to Air Force Commissioning Outcomes, USAFA Outcomes, and have a direct link to the DAF Enlisted and Officer Evaluation Systems.

A4.2. The Likert-Scale for Rating Proficiency.

A4.2.1. Needs Improvement. Cadet needs further growth to enhance understanding and/or performance.

A4.2.2. Developing. Cadet understands the quality and how that quality is illustrated in behavior but requires prompting to consistently demonstrate.

A4.2.3. Proficient. Cadet understands the quality and demonstrates it consistently, illustrated through the Cadet's behavior, forming a part of their character.

A4.2.4. Highly Proficient. Cadet understands the quality and consistently illustrates it in their behavior while influencing other members in the organization to further develop the same quality.

A4.2.5. Exceptionally Skilled. Cadet consistently illustrates this quality in their behavior and proactively influences others' growth in this quality at an organizational scale.

A4.3. Major Performance Areas and Cadet Leadership Qualities. The ten CLQs are grouped into four Major Performance Areas.

A4.3.1. Executing the Mission. Effectively uses knowledge, initiative, and adaptability to produce timely, high quality/quantity results to positively impact the mission.

A4.3.1.1. Job Proficiency. Demonstrates knowledge and professional skill in assigned duties, achieving positive results and impact in support of the mission.

A4.3.1.2. Adaptability. Adjusts to changing conditions, to include plans, information, processes, requirements and obstacles in accomplishing the mission.

A4.3.1.3. Initiative. Assesses and takes independent or directed action to complete a task or mission that influences the mission or organization.

A4.3.2. Leading People. Fosters cohesive teams, effectively communicates, and uses emotional intelligence to take care of people and accomplish the mission.

A4.3.2.1. Inclusion and Teamwork. Collaborates effectively with others to achieve an inclusive climate in pursuit of a common goal or to complete a task or mission, and recognizes/responds to others' needs with empathy and purpose.

A4.3.2.2. Emotional Intelligence. Exercises self-awareness, manages their own emotions effectively, demonstrates an understanding of others' emotions, and appropriately manages professional relationships.

A4.3.2.3. Communication. Articulates information in a clear and timely manner, both verbally and non-verbally, through active listening and messaging tailored to the appropriate audience.

A4.3.3. Managing Resources. Manages assigned resources effectively and takes responsibility for actions/behaviors to maximize organizational performance.

A4.3.3.1. Stewardship. Demonstrates responsible management of assigned resources, which may include time, equipment, people, funds, and/or facilities.

A4.3.3.2. Accountability. Takes responsibility for the actions and behaviors of self and/or team; demonstrates reliability, honesty, and transparency.

A4.3.4. Improving the Unit. Demonstrates critical thinking and fosters innovation to find creative solutions and improve mission execution.

A4.3.4.1. Decision Making. Makes ethical, well-informed, effective, and timely decisions under one's control that weigh constraints, risks, and benefits, and demonstrates the courage to do what is right even if unpopular or at a significant personal cost.

A4.3.4.2. Innovation. Thinks creatively about different ways to solve problems, implements improvements and demonstrates calculated risk-taking.